B1 Vocabulary

Travel and airport vocabulary

The words and phrases you need from check-in to arrival, and the verbs that go with them.

Travel English is very predictable: the same words appear on signs, screens and announcements in every airport. Learn them in the order of your journey.

Stage	Key words	Example
Booking	one-way, return, aisle seat, window seat	*I'd like a return ticket with an aisle seat, please.*
Check-in	check in, luggage, hand luggage, boarding pass	*You can check in online and print your boarding pass.*
Security	go through security, liquids, scanner	*Please put liquids in a clear bag.*
Departure	gate, board, delayed, on time	*Flight EK12 is now boarding at gate 22.*
On the plane	take off, land, seat belt, cabin crew	*Please fasten your seat belt; we are about to take off.*
Arrival	passport control, baggage claim, customs	*After passport control, collect your bags from baggage claim.*

Learn the verb with the noun. You *catch* or *miss* a flight, *board* a plane, *check in* your bags and *collect* them on arrival.

Common mistakes. *Luggage* and *baggage* are uncountable: say *two pieces of luggage* or *two bags*, not *two luggages*. And a plane *takes off*; it does not *fly up*.

Practice

1. Where do you collect your suitcase after the flight?

2. Complete: Hurry up or we'll ___ the flight!
3. Correct the mistake: I have three luggages.
4. What is the opposite of "take off" for a plane?
5. Ask for a seat next to the window at check-in.

▼ **Show answers**

1. At baggage claim.
2. miss
3. I have three bags. / I have three pieces of luggage.
4. land
5. Could I have a window seat, please?